

Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani, Pilani Campus

Department of Humanities and Social Sciences

First Semester 2025-2026

Mid-Semester Test

Course No: GS F211 **Course Title:** Modern Political Concepts **Date & Time:** 06/10/2025, FN1

Marks: 30

Time: 90 Minutes

Answer the following questions

1. How does Thomas Hobbes' view of human passions and desires shape his moral psychology and justify the need for sovereign authority? (5 Marks; 150 words)
2. What is the contribution of behavioural revolution to the development of Political Science as a discipline?
(5 marks; 150 words)
3. Critically engage with Machiavelli's concepts of *virtù* and *fortuna*
(5 marks; 150 words)
4. "A wise prince ought not to keep faith when by doing so it would be against his interest." Discuss.
(5 marks; 150 words)
5. Is democracy compatible with meritocracy? Discuss. (5 marks; 150 words)
6. "Virtue is a state of character concerned with choice, lying in a mean, that is, the mean relative to us, this being determined by reason, and by that reason by which the man of practical wisdom would determine it." Elaborate the statement and critically engage with it.
(5 marks; 150 words)